BILL ATHANASSIOU

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Hiring Manager
Community Health Service
Hunter New England Local Health District
Tamworth NSW 2340

Re: Public Health Officer, Community Health Service, Tamworth

View my ePortfolio
https://b-a7.github.io/health-portfolio/

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am a final-year student at the University of Sydney, applying for the Public Health Officer position with the Community Health Service in Tamworth. Hunter New England Local Health District is the only NSW health district that spans a major city, several large regional centres and remote communities, so its vision of building healthier communities depends on reaching people far from the nearest service. That challenge shapes the work of a regional centre like Tamworth, where health promotion also has to reach smaller towns in which seeing a specialist can mean a long drive. It is the problem I have worked on all semester. Two of my main project experiences in HSBH2009 were centred on older Australians who miss out on care because of age or distance, and I would bring that focus, with an evidence-based approach, to your team.

This role relies on teamwork, independent work and communicating with very different people, and HSBH2009 Innovations in eHealth tested all three. During our Design Project, I drafted half the report independently over the mid-semester break, then reallocated the remaining work with my teammate around our strengths. I then voiced our video as a community health talk for older adults and their families. The marker singled out its closing advice to ask a pharmacist about medication packs. Speaking one-on-one proved harder. In a telehealth role-play I learned to stop explaining and guide a patient through setting up her camera, a skill I would use in any health promotion session run by video.

I also build and evaluate health technology. I designed two simulated patients for a Simu Talk chatbot that trains students in difficult counselling conversations. The same approach could prepare staff and volunteers for health promotion work. Our Design Project showed me that new technology works only when it fits the organisation using it. That is why we chose a pharmacy service built on visits people already make over automated reminder calls. I would apply the same checks on uptake, workload and cost to any new health promotion tool, and keep monitoring it once it was running.

In Tamworth, your values of collaboration and respect would guide how I deliver programs. I would plan health promotion programs together with the pharmacies, general practices and community groups that people in smaller towns already visit. A resident could then pick up advice or a blood pressure check on a visit they were already making, without an extra trip. Where programs run through your virtual care clinics, I would make sure anyone who struggles with video can still take part by phone or in person.

The attached ePortfolio sets out the evidence for each selection criterion. I can start immediately, as the role requires, and can be reached on 0432 564 341 or at bill.athanassiou11@gmail.com. I would welcome the chance to discuss how my evidence-based planning, clear communication and practical use of health technology could support health promotion and community health assessment in Tamworth.

Yours sincerely,

Bill Athanassiou